

Jobs Guarantee Phase One update: 30 April 2026

DWP has selected the first lead Delivery Partners for the Jobs Guarantee programme:

Area	Delivery Partner
Birmingham & Solihull	Catch 22
East Midlands	Ingeus
Greater Manchester	The Growth Company
Hertfordshire and Essex	Reed in Partnership
Central and East Scotland	The King's Trust
South-West and South-East Wales	ITEC Training Solutions Ltd

DWP says it will work with these partners to support the successful rollout of Phase One, and employers interested in offering jobs are being encouraged to contact the relevant local Delivery Partner directly.

Programme Synopsis

The Jobs Guarantee is aimed at young people and will begin in six areas from spring 2026, supporting more than 1,000 young people before a planned wider national rollout later in 2026. The grant guidance says Phase One will support young people through a guaranteed, subsidised paid job, wraparound support and skills/training activity.

Delivery organisations have until October 2026 to assess and place eligible young people and job placements in this phase must be completed by April 2027.

The employer-facing information says the initial rollout is for eligible 18 to 21-year-olds, with wider rollout from autumn 2026 expected to expand to eligible 18 to 24-year-olds. It also describes the offer as a six-month paid job of up to 25 hours per week for young people who have been on Universal Credit for 18 months.

Covering the six-month job placement, the government will fund 100 per cent of wage costs at the minimum wage for up to 25 hours per week, plus employer national insurance and minimum pension contributions.

In addition, delivery organisations can claim up to £2,250 per participant for wraparound support and training, £400 for administration and up to £250 for employer onboarding costs.

YOUTH GUARANTEE
Funded by **UK Government**

Meaningful jobs

Guidance published today stated jobs funded through the scheme must provide “meaningful work”.

This means the job “must not involve significant classroom or online training” and “must be equivalent to a job not funded by the jobs guarantee”.

Delivery organisations also must assess the capacity of the employer and ensure job placements can cater for young people with complex needs.

“It is expected that young people will be placed with reputable employers within the local area,” according to DWP guidance.

It also suggests some flexibility on eligible participants, such as accepting young people who have “minimal work history” over 18 months and 22-24 year olds if there is “spare capacity”.

Policy intent

This is a significant marker in DWP’s wider Get Britain Working agenda. It shows a continuing move toward:

1. Delivery through lead intermediaries

DWP is not simply relying on Jobcentre Plus activity. It is appointing local or regional delivery partners to broker jobs, match young people, support employers and manage wraparound provision.

2. A stronger youth employment focus

The Jobs Guarantee is clearly positioned around preventing long-term youth unemployment and the “scarring” effect of being out of work early in life. DWP’s guidance explicitly links long-term unemployment among young people with major lifetime earnings loss.

3. Employer engagement becoming central

The role of Delivery Partners will be as much about employer brokerage as participant support: securing vacancies, matching young people, helping employers manage risk, and sustaining placements.

4. A likely wider procurement pipeline

YOUTH GUARANTEE

Funded by **UK Government**

Separately, DWP is also undertaking preliminary market engagement for employment support products for the new Jobs and Careers Service, including digital and AI-enabled products. That engagement covers 12 categories including career advice, skills gap analysis, career coaching, job discovery, CV support, application tracking and interview support.

Key implications for the employability and skills sector

For providers, this points to a market that is shifting towards integrated youth employment, employer brokerage, digital career support and sustained in-work progression. The successful organisations are a mix of national employability providers, charities and training/employer-led bodies, which suggests DWP is looking for scale, local labour market knowledge, employer reach and support capability.

For local authorities, combined authorities and SRPs, the announcement matters because the Jobs Guarantee will need to align with existing Youth Guarantee activity, Connect to Work, Careers Hubs, skills bootcamps, SWAPs, local growth plans and employer engagement strategies.

The Jobs Guarantee is part of a wider package of initiatives aimed at reducing the estimated one million young NEETs (not in education, employment, or training).

The wider Youth Guarantee is backed by £820 million over the spending review period, which ministers say will reach almost 900,000 young people, create around 300,000 more work experience and training opportunities, expand youth hubs and fund guaranteed six-month jobs for 55,000 18 to 21-year-olds.

A government-commissioned investigation into young NEETs, led by former Labour minister and social mobility commissioner Alan Milburn, is due to report in September.